

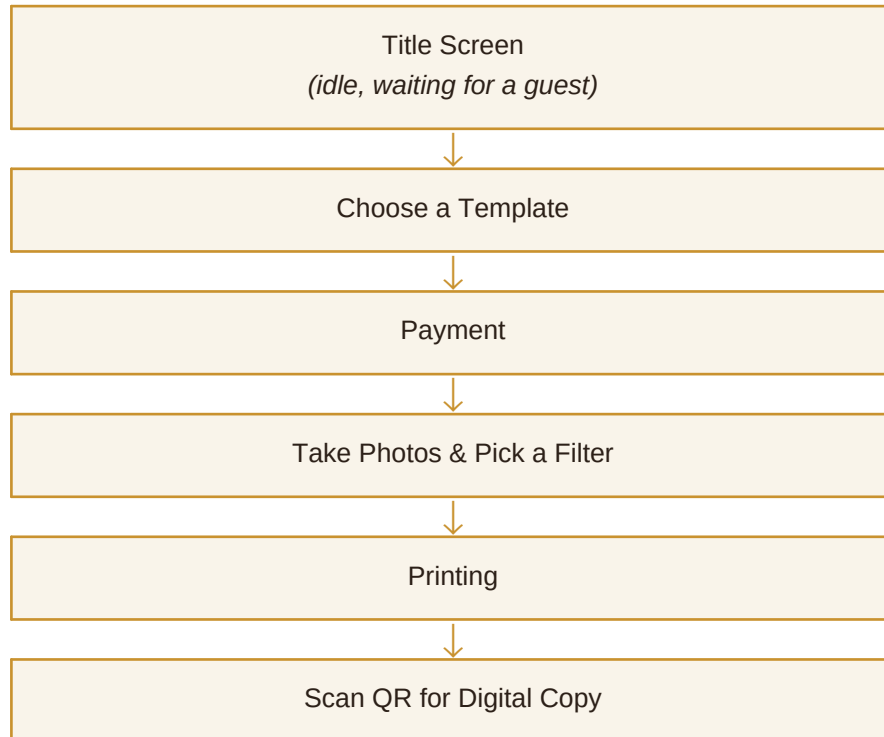
Nostalgia Photobooth

User & Admin Guide

How a guest session runs from start to finish, and how to manage the booth from the Admin Panel.

1. The Guest Experience

This is the flow every guest walks through, from the idle title screen to walking away with a printed strip and a digital copy on their phone.



1.1 Title Screen

The booth sits here between sessions, showing the Nostalgia Photobooth logo (or your own uploaded logo) and a “Click Here to Start” button. A background image can also be customized in Settings.

Staff access: tap the small circular badge in the top-right corner three times within two seconds to jump straight into the Admin Panel. There is no password on this gesture, so keep it in mind if guests are near the screen unsupervised.

1.2 Choose a Template

The guest sees a carousel of available photo templates — the current one enlarged in the center, with neighboring templates dimmed on either side. They tap the arrows or a side template to browse, and tap the centered template to select it. Dots above the carousel show how many templates are active. If the screen sits idle for 60 seconds, a warning appears and the booth returns to the title screen after a 10-second countdown.

1.3 Payment

The guest sees the price for the chosen template (or the default session price if that template has none set) and a progress indicator as payment is made. Payment itself is handled by the connected bill acceptor / payment hardware — this screen simply waits for confirmation. Once the amount is met, it shows “Payment Received” and moves on to the camera automatically. A Back button is available to cancel the sale before payment starts.

1.4 Taking Photos

The guest sees a live camera preview inside the frame style you've configured (wooden, blurred edge, solid color, custom image, or none), with guide lines showing exactly what will print. They can:

- Pick a filter (default color, Sepia, Black & White, Fujifilm, or any custom filter you've added) by tapping a filter button.
- Toggle Mirror mode for a more natural selfie-style view.
- Tap Start to begin a 3-second countdown with a flash effect before each capture.

A running thumbnail strip on the side fills in as photos are captured, labeled “Photo X of Y” until the template's required photo count is reached, after which the booth moves on to printing automatically. Backing out mid-session warns the guest that captured photos will be discarded.

1.5 Printing

An animated strip “falls” into a printer slot on screen while the real print job runs, with a status message (Printing... / Photo printed! / or Print failed with a Retry option) and a short countdown before the booth advances automatically. A Done button is available to skip ahead immediately.

1.6 Digital Copy (QR Code)

The final screen shows a QR code the guest scans with their phone to open their private online gallery for that session. There they can view the finished template, a collage grid of every shot, and an animated GIF, and save any of them straight to their camera roll. If the upload didn't go through, a friendly message asks them to check with staff instead. The guest taps Done when finished, returning the booth to the title screen for the next customer.

2. The Admin Panel

Reached with the hidden 3-tap gesture on the title screen. This is where you track sales, manage templates and branding, and browse or reprint past photos.

2.1 Dashboard — Sales & Reporting

The Dashboard tab gives you a full sales overview:

- **Sales Summary** — total pieces sold and total revenue, filterable by Day, Month, Year, or All time.
- **Sales by Item** — a table of Photo Strips, Reprints, and any custom add-on items (e.g. keychains, mugs), each with editable price and quantity sold. Custom items can be added or removed at any time.
- **Sales by Template** — per-template pieces sold, unit price, and total, individually editable.
- **Export to Excel** — downloads a formatted spreadsheet of whatever view/filter is currently on screen.
- **Reset** — wipes all sales data, prices, reprint totals, and custom items. This requires the admin password to confirm and cannot be undone — use with care.

2.2 Settings

Everything about how the booth looks and behaves is configured here:

- **Branding** — upload/clear your own logo and title-screen background image; upload custom display/body fonts.
- **Camera filters** — upload custom .cube color-grading filters (LUTs), name them, toggle them active/inactive, or remove them.
- **Camera frame** — choose the on-screen border style during capture: wooden, blurred edge, solid color (with color picker), a custom uploaded image, or none.
- **Printer** — select which connected printer to use, number of copies per print, cut mode, and a shortcut to the Windows printer-properties dialog for hardware-specific options (e.g. the physical 2-inch-cut toggle).
- **Templates** — add new templates with a custom name, optional frame artwork, any grid size (rows × columns), paper size (4×6 portrait/landscape or 2×6 strip), margin/gap/zoom, a price, and thumbnail images — with a live preview before saving. Existing templates can be set active/inactive or deleted.

2.3 Gallery — Browse, Reprint & Delete

The Gallery tab has two views — **Session** (photos from recent booth sessions) and **Saved** (every photo saved to disk on this PC). From either view you can select one or more photos and:

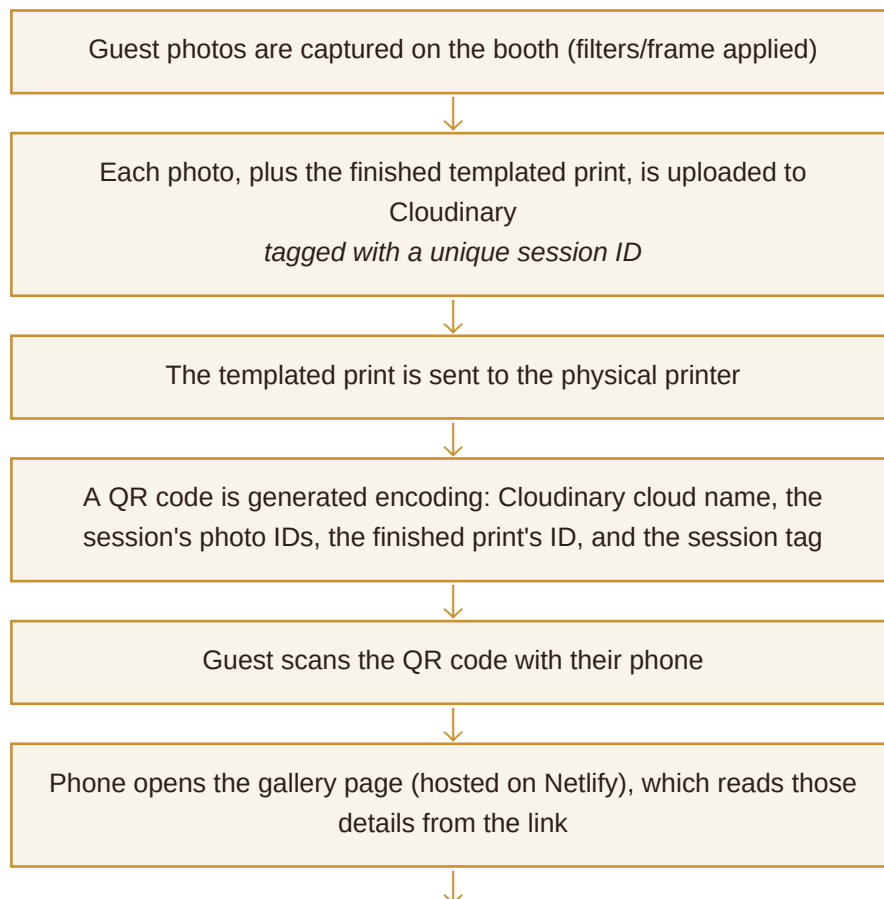
- **Reprint** — choose a copy count and reprint the exact original sheet (this is automatically recorded as a sale on the Dashboard).
- **Delete** — remove photos you no longer need.
- Open any photo full-size for quick Reprint/Delete, or download a copy to a file.

3. How It All Connects

The booth app itself runs entirely on the mini PC and works offline for capturing and printing. Two outside services make the “digital copy” part of the experience possible:

- **Cloudinary** — cloud storage that receives a copy of every photo and the finished template so they can be viewed from a phone.
- **Netlify** — hosts the public gallery web page that the QR code links to (the page guests see when they scan).

3.1 End-to-End Process Flow



Gallery page shows three tabs — **Template** (the actual finished print), **Grid** (all captures collaged), and **GIF** (all captures animated) — with a Save to Camera Roll button

If the internet connection drops during a session and the upload fails, printing still succeeds locally — the guest just sees a message on the QR screen asking them to check with staff for a digital copy instead.

3.2 Where Each Piece Lives

Component	What it is	Where it lives
Booth app	The kiosk software guests interact with	Runs locally on the mini PC (Electron app)
Payment middleware	Drives the bill acceptor / QR payment hardware and reports completed sales to the booth	Runs locally on the mini PC (LumaBooth Middleware)
Cloudinary	Cloud storage for uploaded photos	Cloudinary.com (client's own account)
Gallery page	The web page the QR code opens	Hosted on Netlify, in its own project/repository

3.3 Payment Integration (LumaBooth Middleware)

The Payment screen doesn't talk to the bill acceptor or QR payment reader directly. A separate, small background app on the same mini PC — the **LumaBooth Middleware** — handles the physical hardware (bill acceptor and PayMongo QR payments) and reports back to the booth the moment a sale completes. The booth app listens for that signal on the mini PC itself (nothing goes over the internet for this step) and credits the session automatically, moving the guest on to the camera.

This means the payment hardware and its software both need to be installed and running on the mini PC alongside the booth app — it isn't something configured from within the booth's own Admin Panel.

4. Cloudinary Setup (Cloud Photo Storage)

Cloudinary is the cloud service that stores a copy of every photo and templated print so guests can access them from their phones. The booth is currently connected to your own Cloudinary account.

4.1 Current Configuration

The booth connects to Cloudinary using two values, set in the app's configuration file:

```
VITE_CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME = uprdu3kg
VITE_CLOUDINARY_UPLOAD_PRESET = nostalgia-photobooth
```

The **cloud name** identifies your Cloudinary account. The **upload preset** is a saved upload configuration inside that account — it must be set to **Unsigned** mode so the booth can upload directly without exposing any private API keys.

4.2 How Uploads Work

- Every photo is saved locally first — this always succeeds, even offline.
- Right after, the app uploads each photo (and the finished template) to Cloudinary, tagged with a unique ID for that session.
- If the upload fails (e.g. no internet), the local save and printed copy are unaffected — only the QR-code digital-copy feature is impacted for that session.
- Uploaded photos can be browsed anytime in the Cloudinary Media Library under your account.

4.3 If You Ever Need to Reconnect a Different Cloudinary Account

- 1 Get the new account's **Cloud Name** from Cloudinary Dashboard → Settings → General.
- 2 Create a new **Upload Preset** under Settings → Upload → Add upload preset, and set its Signing Mode to **Unsigned**.
- 3 Update the two values shown above in the app's configuration file with the new cloud name and preset name.
- 4 Restart the booth app so the new values take effect.

This is a developer-level change — reach out to your development contact if you need this done.

5. QR Gallery Page (Hosted on Netlify)

When a guest scans the QR code on their printed strip, it opens a simple web page — not part of the booth app itself — that shows their photos and lets them save copies to their phone. This page is hosted separately on Netlify, a web hosting service, so it stays fast and available independent of the booth's own mini PC.

5.1 Current Setup

Live URL	https://nostalgia-qr.netlify.app
Source repository	github.com/eventsnostalgiaphotobooth04-star/nostalgia-qr
Hosting	Netlify (auto-deploys whenever the repository is updated)

The booth app is configured to point its QR codes at this URL via the `VITE_GALLERY_BASE_URL` setting in its configuration file.

5.2 What the Gallery Page Shows

The page reads details from the link the QR code encodes (which Cloudinary account, which photo IDs, which finished print, and the session tag) and builds three tabs:

- **Template** — the actual finished, framed print exactly as it was printed.
- **Grid** — every individual capture collaged together into one image.
- **GIF** — an animated GIF cycling through every capture.

A big “Save to Camera Roll” button saves the current tab's image; a secondary link lets the guest save individual photos one at a time.

5.3 Updating the Gallery Page

Because this page lives in its own separate repository, it can be updated and redeployed independently of the booth app — a design/content change here doesn't require rebuilding or reinstalling anything on the mini PC. Changes pushed to the repository automatically redeploy to the live URL within about a minute via Netlify. If the gallery is ever moved to a new URL, the booth's `VITE_GALLERY_BASE_URL` setting needs to be updated to match, and the app restarted.

This is a developer-level change — reach out to your development contact if you need this done.

For first-time hardware setup (extracting and launching the app on your mini PC), see the separate Setup Guide.